12-22 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Afternoon Mum and I Sorted Thirty Years of Family Photos

① On a cold and lazy Saturday afternoon, **18 December 2027, at 14:00**, my mother opened the tall wooden door of the small storage room at the end of our hallway and said, with unusual seriousness in her voice, *"Yiran, bring two small clean cloths and the yellow low stool. Today you and I are going to finally sort out those old family photo boxes. It will take about **three hours**. If we do not do it this winter, I am afraid we never will."* I had seen the three brown cardboard boxes on the top shelf of that room **for my whole fourteen-year life**. I had never opened any of them. My mother had, once in a while, muttered the word *"someday"* in their direction, then closed the door. On that Saturday, the *"someday"* finally arrived.

② We set the three boxes — each about the size of a medium watermelon, dusty on the top, labelled in my grandmother's careful handwriting with the years **1991—1997**, **1998—2006**, and **2007—2015** — onto the red-tiled living-room floor. My mother laid out, on the carpet, four clean A3 pieces of craft paper. On the first she wrote, in blue marker, **"Keep — family album (2028)"**. On the second, **"Digitise only (scan and file)"**. On the third, **"Give to the photo's owner"**. On the fourth, in smaller letters, **"Let go gently"**. *"Four piles, Yiran. Four quiet piles. No pile is bigger than another in importance."* I sat down on the yellow low stool, a clean white cloth in my hand, and we began.

③ The first box opened with a small dry sigh — the lid had not been lifted for six years. Inside were loose paper photos, some in thin pale cardboard sleeves, some with small white borders, almost all of them **not digital**. My mother picked up the first photo. It was a dull-brown square picture of a young woman in a navy-blue sweater holding a six-month-old baby, both of them half smiling, half surprised, in a small hospital corridor. The date on the back, written in careful pencil, said **"1991-10-04, Wuxi Renmin Hospital, Mum + Xiaohui, 1-day old"**. My mother looked at the photo for a long quiet time. Then she showed it to me. *"Yiran,"* she said softly, *"this is your grandmother, holding me on the day after I was born."* My grandmother had passed away when I was eleven. I had never seen her at thirty years old. I had only seen her at sixty-eight.

④ *"Pile one,"* my mother said. She placed the photo carefully on **"Keep"**.

⑤ The afternoon went on, slowly and quietly. Every photo had a small story. A photo of my mother **at seven**, in a red school uniform, holding a single green apple, at the school's "harvest day" in 1998 — *"I cried because I dropped the apple before my turn, and a classmate lent me hers."* A small black-and-white photo of my **late grandfather as a young soldier in 1974**, looking straight at the camera with steady quiet eyes — *"Your*

grandpa served two years in the army. He never, in forty years, told this story in full; I learnt it only from letters after he died." A tiny passport-sized photo of my mother and father **the week they met in university**, 2006, each of them looking slightly awkward, not touching, standing a formal thirty centimetres apart. My mother laughed at this one. *"This is the shyest your father has ever looked. He is still a shy man, but he hides it better now."*

⑥ Not everything went into **"Keep"**. In the second box, we found **eleven photos of a childhood friend of my mother's, Ms Xu**, with whom my mother had lost contact around 2009 after Ms Xu moved to Guangzhou. My mother looked at them for a while. Then she quietly put all eleven photos into the **"Give to the photo's owner"** pile. *"Yiran,"* she said, *"these are not really my memories. They are hers. I will write her a short letter, put the eleven photos in a padded envelope, and send them to her in Guangzhou. That is where they belong."* I did not expect this. I had thought memory was a thing we all kept forever. My mother had just quietly taught me something — that some memories are kept best by giving them to the person who truly lived them.

⑦ The **"Let go gently"** pile surprised me the most. There were about **fifteen blurry photos** — an out-of-focus sunset in 2004, a shoe photographed by mistake, a thumb over half of a birthday cake in 2012. My mother put these carefully on the fourth pile, but she did not throw them away yet. *"Never throw photos away in a hurry, Yiran,"* she said. *"First we let them sit in this pile for one week. If none of them, after one week, comes back into our memory with a small pull, then they are ready to go. Photos are like small quiet people; we thank them before we let them go."* I thought this was a strange, gentle rule. I wrote it down mentally.

⑧ At **16:50**, two hours and fifty minutes into the afternoon, we took a break. My mother made us a small tray: two cups of warm ginger tea, one small plate of walnuts, one small plate of mandarin oranges. We sat on the carpet among the four piles and did not speak for five minutes. Outside the window, a thin winter light was turning orange; a single crow was sitting quietly on the neighbour's balcony. My mother said, softly, looking at the **"Keep"** pile, which was now about **seventy-one photos** high, *"Yiran, in January I will buy two thick beige albums, and we will sort these into them with small handwritten captions. That will be the new 2028 family album. Our real one."* I nodded. I felt, for the first time in my life, that our family had a small quiet thread going backwards forty years — a thread that would not break, because the two of us were gently tying each small knot.

⑨ At **17:30**, we finished. The three old brown boxes were now four small paper piles on four sheets of A3 paper. The **"Keep"** pile had **71 photos**; the **"Digitise only"** pile had **62** (Mum would scan them with her phone next weekend); the **"Give to photo's owner"** pile had **18** (Ms Xu's 11, and 7 for a cousin in Chengdu); the **"Let go gently"** pile had **14**. My mother covered each pile with a clean cloth, wrote small green paper labels, and slid the four piles, carefully, onto the lowest shelf of the bookcase in the living-room, where I would see them every day for a quiet week.

⑩ On the way to bed that evening, my mother stopped me at the doorway of my room. She held, in her hand, one single photo — the first one we had opened: my grandmother at thirty, holding my one-day-old mother in 1991. *"Yiran,"* she said, *"this one belongs to you from today. Keep it in the little green notebook beside your bed. When you are my age, and I am not here, it will matter to you. I promise."* I took the photo very carefully with both hands. I did not trust my voice. I nodded. That night I slipped the photo into my small green one-sentence notebook. My one sentence for the day, at 22:16, was this: *"Today Mum and I sorted thirty years, and gave me a grandmother I had never seen at thirty."*

注释： digitise 数字化；caption 图说；sleeve 相片夹；padded envelope 气泡信封；mandarin orange 柑橘；carpet 地毯

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. According to Paragraph ② and ③, what simple system did the writer's mother set up for sorting the photos, and what was the first photo they opened?

A. The mother set up a single pile of "keep everything" and the first photo was a colour photo of the beach.
B. The mother set up two piles of "sell" and "throw" and the first photo was a magazine page.
C. The mother laid out four A3 craft papers on the carpet and wrote in blue marker the four piles: "Keep — family album (2028)", "Digitise only (scan and file)", "Give to the photo's owner", and "Let go gently" (quietly saying "no pile is bigger than another in importance"); the first box opened with a small dry sigh (unopened for six years) containing mostly non-digital paper photos, and the first photo was a dull-brown square picture of a young woman in a navy-blue sweater holding a six-month-old baby, with pencil writing on the back "1991-10-04, Wuxi Renmin Hospital, Mum + Xiaohui, 1-day old" — this was the writer's late grandmother at thirty holding the writer's mother the day after she was born, a sight the writer had never seen (her grandmother had passed when she was eleven and she had only seen her at sixty-eight).
D. The mother destroyed every photo and took pictures of the empty boxes.

2. Which of the following stories behind specific photos is correctly matched to the writer's family (Paragraph ⑤)?

A. A photo of the writer's mother at three years old receiving a gold medal.
B. A photo of the writer's mother at seven in a red school uniform holding a single green apple at "harvest day" in 1998 (she cried because she dropped the apple before her turn and a classmate lent her hers); a small black-and-white photo of the writer's late grandfather as a young soldier in 1974 with steady quiet eyes (who served two years in the army and never in forty years told the story in full — the mother learnt it only from letters after he died); and a tiny passport-sized photo of the writer's mother and father

the week they met in university in 2006, each slightly awkward, not touching, standing a formal thirty centimetres apart (the mother laughed because "this is the shyest your father has ever looked; he is still a shy man, but he hides it better now").
C. A photo of the writer's father winning an Olympic medal.
D. A photo of the writer's mother holding a snake at age five.

3. Why did the writer's mother place the eleven photos of Ms Xu into the "Give to the photo's owner" pile, and what lesson did the writer learn (Paragraph ⑥)?

A. Because Ms Xu demanded her photos back.
B. The mother found eleven photos of a childhood friend, Ms Xu, with whom she had lost contact around 2009 after Ms Xu moved to Guangzhou; after looking at them a while she put all eleven into the "Give to the photo's owner" pile, saying "these are not really my memories. They are hers. I will write her a short letter, put the eleven photos in a padded envelope, and send them to her in Guangzhou. That is where they belong"; the writer, who had thought memory was a thing everyone kept forever, quietly learnt that some memories are kept best by giving them to the person who truly lived them.
C. Because Ms Xu had stolen the photos originally.
D. Because the mother disliked the photos and wanted them gone.

4. What is the rule the mother taught about the "Let go gently" pile (Paragraph ⑦)?

A. Throw away every blurry photo immediately in a bin outside.
B. Burn every unclear photo.
C. In the "Let go gently" pile were about fifteen blurry photos (an out-of-focus sunset in 2004, a shoe photographed by mistake, a thumb over half of a birthday cake in 2012); the mother's rule was: "Never throw photos away in a hurry. First we let them sit in this pile for one week. If none of them, after one week, comes back into our memory with a small pull, then they are ready to go. Photos are like small quiet people; we thank them before we let them go" — a strange, gentle rule the writer wrote down mentally.
D. Sell the blurry photos online for cash.

5. What specific gift did the mother give the writer at bedtime, and what does this moment quietly teach?

A. The mother gave the writer a brand-new phone.
B. The mother gave the writer her own diary.
C. On the way to bed the mother stopped the writer at the doorway and held the first photo they had opened — the grandmother at thirty holding the one-day-old mother in 1991 — saying "this one belongs to you from today. Keep it in the little green notebook beside your bed. When you are my age, and I am not here, it will matter to you. I promise"; the writer, unable to trust her voice, took the photo carefully, slipped it into her one-sentence notebook, and wrote that evening "Today Mum and I sorted thirty years, and gave me a grandmother I had never seen at thirty" — quietly showing that the afternoon's work tied a small, lasting family thread back across forty years, one careful

knot at a time.
D. The mother gave the writer a new coat.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②③段四堆 + 第一张照片
【解析】"四张 A3 / 四堆名称 / 无锡人医 1991 / 奶奶 30 岁"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段每张照片故事
【解析】"苹果 1998 / 爷爷 1974 军 / 父母 2006 相遇"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段许阿姨 11 张
【解析】"不是我的记忆 / 寄广州 / 属于她"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 Let go gently
【解析】"15 张模糊 / 静置一周 / 无小牵挂才放 / 感谢后再放"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题 / 推理判断题
【定位】第⑩段睡前赠照片
【解析】"从今天属于你 / 不在时更重要 / 小笔记本 / 见到 30 岁奶奶"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。